

KELROY JAMES

Supply Chain Assurance (Logistics & Movements) | Operational Controls | Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Supply chain assurance and operational controls specialist combining 18 years of Defence logistics and movements experience, preceded by 12 years in critical national infrastructure (electricity utility), with formal quantitative training through the MIT MicroMasters in Supply Chain Management (coursework complete; final exam November 2026). First-line owner (1LOD) of a public sector account under the Royal Navy's four-tier logistics assurance model (BRd 93), applying Lean Six Sigma principles for continuous improvement. Seeking manager-level or senior consultant roles in supply chain assurance and operational controls, with third-party risk, GRC consulting and internal audit as adjacent routes, at professional services firms, banks and defence primes, most realistically through structured veteran or military-transition hiring routes. Track record of closing the gap between records and physical reality through systematic controls, root-cause investigation and enterprise-level process improvement.

Core Skills: Supply Chain Assurance (Logistics & Movements) | Operational Controls | First-Line Risk Ownership (1LOD) | Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) | Financial Control & Root-Cause Analysis | Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (Continuous Improvement) | Third-Party Risk Management | ISO/IEC 27001, 42001, 27701 | Three Lines Model | Export Control & Trade Compliance (ITAR, EAR) | Dangerous Goods Compliance (IMDG Code, ADR, IATA DGR) | Digital Transformation (Palantir Foundry) | Data Analytics (SQL, Python, Power BI) | PRINCE2 Project Governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Petty Officer (Supply Chain Manager)

Royal Navy, Type 45 Destroyer | May 2024 – Present

- Took over an account graded unsatisfactory at Fleet Logistics Inspection; identified £2.4M in misallocated expenditure through financial control analysis
- Led the root-cause work behind its correction, restoring full compliance within 12 months
- Informed a proposed Navy-wide policy instruction to prevent recurrence
- Owned requirements and data redesign for the STOROB inventory application feeding Palantir Foundry, reconfiguring the source spreadsheet and testing the output against real cases with the project manager and unit stakeholders; the rebuilt tool identified a complex STOROB worth £8,000 and 50 man-hours on first use, was rolled out to an adjacent unit, and has since been adopted by inventory managers elsewhere in the fleet
- In a separate asset verification and documentation remediation initiative on the same account, reduced financial liability by 80%; assessed favourably against the wider Surface Flotilla HQ peer group, a comparison against the whole peer group rather than a single trade
- Founded "Empowerment Day" within Engineering Support Group 1 to build junior rates' self-awareness and career development, adopted as a standing programme

Petty Officer (Supply Chain and Global Movements)

Royal Navy, Wildcat Maritime Force | Apr 2022 – May 2024

- Consolidated dispersed Force Mobile Equipment into a single accountable stock holding site, closing 14 major loss investigations
- Held concurrent responsibility for the unit's global movements coordination, alongside stores accountability, covering international freight, customs documentation and multi-modal consignment tracking across deployed locations
- Led a nine-person team through a £5M weapons trial and Exercise Tamber Shield deployments, turning round a rejected consignment in 3 days to make a fixed flight slot and recovering a mid-exercise equipment shortfall with 3 hours to spare
- Completed a strategic innovation course and introduced Mission Model Canvas training to build the team's strategic awareness of innovation; six of the nine team members have since been promoted

Section Head, Supply Chain (Petty Officer)

Royal Navy, Surface Flotilla Engineering Support (WLSG) | Jun 2021 – Apr 2022

- Took on Section Head responsibilities immediately upon promotion to Petty Officer, delivering Tier 1 Compliance Management Tool assurance across the Type 45, Type 23 and Hunt-class mine countermeasures fleets
- Led the logistics workstream of the Garage Lite lean-maintenance trial: £145,674 of stores handled with zero losses on return, and the highest rate of demands placed before T-12 of any Type 45 Fleet Time Support Period that year
- Selected for the Percy Hobart Innovation Fellowship, a 12-week digital transformation programme, developing a project on sustainable consignment tracking

Senior Rate Leadership Course & Type 45 Class Output Management Cell

Royal Navy, Fleet Time Support Period (FTSP) | Nov 2020 – Jun 2021

- Selected for promotion to Petty Officer (Supply Chain) in October 2020; completed the Senior Rate Leadership Course and served within the Type 45 Class Output Management Cell ahead of appointment as Section Head, Supply Chain in June 2021

Leading Hand (Supply Chain)

Royal Navy, HMS Defender (Type 45 Destroyer) | Mar 2020 – Nov 2020

- Deputised for the Section Head across the ship's Naval Stores Account throughout an intensive pre-deployment training work-up, maintaining full compliance under sustained operational pressure
- Coordinated a de-ammunitioning evolution with Royal Navy and MOD stakeholders and no senior-rate oversight, delivering it safely ahead of a fleet exercise

Leading Hand, Fleet Stores Coordination Cell

Royal Navy, Fleet Operations (Maritime Operations Centre) | Jul 2018 – Mar 2020

- Provided 24/7 watchkeeping cover for Fleet-wide operational-defect logistics, sustaining concurrent support to a carrier strike group deployment, a major Middle East exercise and a NATO High North exercise
- Rated the strongest among peer Leading Hands across two reporting periods; selected to understudy the Petty Officer billet

Leading Hand (Supply Chain Supervisor)

Royal Navy, Fleet Diving Squadron HQ | Dec 2016 – Jun 2018

- Sole logistician for Fleet Diving Squadron's Portsmouth-based units; designed and delivered an organic, PRINCE2-governed consignment tracking capability, eliminating a 200-mile round-trip dependency and sustaining exercises across 4 nations

- Concurrently performed Warrant-Officer-level movements officer duties; awarded the Chief Naval Logistics Officer's Award for coaching and mentoring (2018)

Supply Chain Specialist / Logistics Inspector

Royal Navy, Various Postings | 2008 – 2016

- Sole logistics point of contact for a Joint Forces Logistics Unit in the Falkland Islands, managing a £30K monthly Government Procurement Card budget and cutting low-value purchase orders by 80%
- Restructured Ministry of Defence inventory accounting (MJDI) across 31 NATO locations while posted to the European Joint Support Unit at SHAPE, Belgium

GIS Analyst & Infrastructure Planner

St Vincent Electricity Services (Critical National Infrastructure) | 1996 – 2008

- Led GPS geo-tagging of national grid infrastructure (12,000+ assets), underpinning an Esri Special Achievement in GIS Award-winning enterprise mapping system
- Advanced from meter reader to planning specialist through self-directed capability development; awarded Employee of the Year for operational excellence

EDUCATION

- MSc Supply Chain and Logistics Management (Defence Logistics Staff Course), University of Lincoln: In Progress (Distinction track), Apr 2025 – Mar 2027; route to MCIPS, eligible for CMILT on transition
- MicroMasters, Supply Chain Management & Advanced Network Design, MIT Center for Transportation & Logistics: coursework complete (5 core courses + advanced elective), comprehensive final exam November 2026
- Professional Award in Cyber Security & OSINT, Abertay University: Distinction, 2023–2025
- MicroMasters, Predictive Analytics using Python, University of Edinburgh: 2021–2022
- BSc (Hons) Logistics and Operations Management, Aston University: 2:1, 2017–2019
- FdSc Logistics Management, University of Lincoln: 2016–2018

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022, 42001:2023 & 27701:2025 Lead Auditor. Fellow of Management Systems Auditing (FellowMSA): Mastermind Assurance
 - CompTIA PenTest+ ce
 - Forward Program (Advanced Professional Development), McKinsey & Company: 2024
 - Richmond Fellowship, Royal Navy Strategic Studies Centre: 2025–2026
- Full certification record and continuing education: kelroyjames.com/skills-expertise.html

AWARDS

- Innovation Award, Royal Navy Inclusivity Awards: 2023, RNAS Yeovilton, for championing and helping ethnic minority personnel, including recruiting members for the McKinsey Connected Leaders Academy (reported in Navy News, July 2023)
- Herbert Lott Efficiency Award: 2019, Fleet Stores Coordination Cell team award, Fleet Operations (Northwood)
- Chief Naval Logistics Officer's Award, Supply Chain Branch: 2018, for dangerous goods training delivery to EOD personnel, SOP authorship and mentoring ahead of RN Qualifying Courses

Portfolio with full case studies, published frameworks and case-study evidence for every metric above: kelroyjames.com

Available now for exploratory conversations and professional networking while serving. Available for full-time roles from April 2028 (resettlement). For a direct number, email or use the LinkedIn contact above.